

APPENDIX B

CLI Flags and Subcommands

Subcommands first, then flags. Flags marked print mode only apply with `-p`. See Chapter 17 for the headless contract.

Generated from the official docs snapshot of 2026-09-10 (Claude Code v2.1.267) by tools/gen_appendices.py. Do not edit by hand; rerun the script for the next edition.

Subcommands

- `claude`: start interactive session
- `claude "query"`: interactive session with initial prompt
- `claude -p "query"`: query via SDK then exit
- `claude -c`: continue most recent conversation
- `claude -c -p "query"`: continue via SDK
- `claude -r "<session>" "query"`: resume session by ID or name
- `claude update`: update to latest version
- `claude gateway`: start self-hosted Claude apps gateway server
- `claude install [version]`: install or reinstall native binary
- `claude auth login`: sign in; `--email`, `--sso`, `--console`
- `claude auth logout`: log out

- `claude auth status`: authentication status JSON; `--text`
- `claude agents: open agent view`; `--cwd`, `--json`, `--all`
- `claude attach <id>`: attach to background session
- `claude auto-mode defaults`: print built-in auto mode rules; `--label`
- `claude auto-mode config`: show effective auto mode config
- `claude auto-mode reset`: restore default auto mode config; `--yes`
- `claude daemon status`: print supervisor state
- `claude daemon stop --any`: stop supervisor; `--keep-workers`
- `claude doctor`: read-only install and settings diagnostics
- `claude import [codex|gemini|cursor]`: import config from other agents; `--dry-run`, `--yes`
- `claude logs <id>`: print background session output
- `claude mcp`: configure MCP servers
- `claude mcp login <name>`: run MCP OAuth flow; `--no-browser`
- `claude mcp logout <name>`: clear MCP OAuth credentials
- `claude plugin`: manage plugins; alias `claude plugins`
- `claude project purge [path]`: delete local project state; `--dry-run`, `--yes`, `--interactive`, `--all`
- `claude remote-control`: start Remote Control server
- `claude respawn <id>`: restart background session; `--all`
- `claude rm <id> [--discard-unpushed <commit>@<worktree-id>]`: remove background session from list; discard a refused worktree's unpushed commits (v2.1.260+)
- `claude self-hosted-runner`: host cloud sessions on own infrastructure; `setup`, `doctor`, `orchestrator`
- `claude setup-token`: generate long-lived OAuth token
- `claude stop <id>`: stop background session; alias `claude kill`
- `claude ultrareview [target]`: non-interactive ultrareview; `--json`, `--timeout`, `--post`, `--no-post`

Flags

- `--add-dir`: add additional working directories
- `--advisor <model>`: enable server-side advisor tool
- `--agent`: specify agent for session
- `--agents`: define subagents via JSON
- `--allow-dangerously-skip-permissions`: add `bypassPermissions` to mode cycle
- `--append-subagent-system-prompt`: append text to subagent prompts
- `--append-subagent-system-prompt-file`: append a file's text to subagent prompts; -p only; v2.1.261+
- `--append-system-prompt`: append text to system prompt
- `--append-system-prompt-file`: append file to system prompt
- `--autocompact <auto|tokens>`: set auto-compact window for session
- `--ax-screen-reader`: screen-reader friendly output
- `--bare`: minimal mode skipping auto-discovery
- `--betas`: beta headers for API requests
- `--channels`: MCP channel notification servers (research preview)
- `--chrome`: enable Chrome browser integration
- `--cloud`: create or message web session
- `--dangerously-load-development-channels`: load non-allowlisted channels
- `--dangerously-skip-permissions`: skip permission prompts
- `--debug`: enable debug mode with category filter
- `--debug-file <path>`: write debug logs to file
- `--disable-slash-commands`: disable all skills and commands
- `--effort`: set effort level
- `--enable-auto-mode`: removed; use `--permission-mode auto`
- `--environment <environment-id>`: cloud session on self-hosted environment
- `--exclude-dynamic-system-prompt-sections`: move per-machine sections to user message
- `--exec`: run shell command as background job
- `--fallback-model`: fallback model chain

- `--fork-session`: new session ID when resuming
- `--forward-subagent-text`: emit subagent text in stream output
- `--from-pr`: session picker filtered by pull request
- `--ide`: auto-connect to IDE
- `--init`: run Setup hooks with init matcher
- `--init-only`: run Setup and SessionStart hooks, exit
- `--include-hook-events`: include hook events in stream output
- `--include-partial-messages`: include partial streaming events
- `--input-format`: print mode input format
- `--json-schema`: validated JSON output matching schema
- `--maintenance`: run Setup hooks with maintenance matcher
- `--max-budget-usd`: dollar spend cap (print mode)
- `--max-turns`: limit agentic turns (print mode)
- `--mcp-config`: load MCP servers from JSON
- `--model`: set model for session
- `--no-chrome`: disable Chrome integration
- `--no-session-persistence`: don't save session to disk
- `--output-format`: print mode output format
- `--permission-mode`: begin in permission mode
- `--permission-prompts <host|none>`: who answers permission prompts in print mode; none denies them; v2.1.259+
- `--permission-prompt-tool`: MCP tool for permission prompts
- `--plugin-dir`: load plugin from directory or zip, or a folder of plugins (v2.1.265+)
- `--plugin-url`: fetch plugin zip from URL
- `--prompt-suggestions`: emit `prompt_suggestion` messages
- `--ref <branch>`: base environment checkout on ref
- `--remote`: deprecated alias for `--cloud`
- `--remote-control-session-name-prefix <prefix>`: prefix for auto-generated session names
- `--replay-user-messages`: re-emit stdin user messages
- `--restricted`: restricted mode for evaluation harnesses

- `--safe-mode`: start with all customizations disabled
- `--session-id`: use specific UUID session ID
- `--setting-sources`: setting sources to load
- `--settings`: settings file or inline JSON
- `--strict-mcp-config`: only MCP servers from `--mcp-config`
- `--system-prompt`: replace entire system prompt
- `--system-prompt-file`: replace system prompt from file
- `--system-prompt-snapshot <on|off>`: off rebuilds the system prompt on every request instead of reusing the recorded one; v2.1.267+
- `--teleport`: resume web session locally
- `--teammate-mode`: agent team display mode
- `--tmux`: tmux session for worktree; `--tmux=classic`
- `--tools`: restrict built-in tools
- `--verbose`: verbose turn-by-turn logging